

more rigid. Consider whether you need an IDE that can be easily tailored to your specific needs.

Community and support: Look for an IDE with a large and active community, as this will ensure that there are plenty of resources, tutorials, and support available.

Integration with other tools: If you are already using tools like testing frameworks, build systems, or other libraries, look for an IDE that can integrate with them seamlessly.

Cost: Consider the cost of the IDE and whether it fits your budget. Some IDEs are free and open source, while others are commercial.

Learning curve: If you are new to programming, you may want to consider an IDE with a steeper learning curve, as this will provide a more comprehensive set of tools and features.

Personal preference: Finally, consider your personal preference, as the IDE that works best for one developer may not work as well for another.

The best IDE for you will depend on your specific needs and preferences, as well as the programming languages and tools that you are working with. It's advisable to try several IDEs and choose the one that you feel most comfortable and productive with.

Popular IDEs are:

- Visual Studio Code
- Eclipse
- IntelliJ IDEA
- Code::Blocks
- PyCharm

Note that this list may change over time and different developers may have their own preferences based on their experience, programming languages they are working with, and the specific features they are looking for in an IDE.

Visual Studio Code (VS Code)

One of the most popular IDEs is Visual Studio Code (VS Code). It is developed by Microsoft and has a large and active community of developers. It is developed on the Electron Framework,

for Windows, Linux and macOS. Its key features include:

- *Intuitive user interface:* VS Code has a clean and modern user interface that is easy to navigate and customise.
- *Built-in support for debugging:* It includes a built-in debugging tool that allows developers to step through their code, set breakpoints, and inspect the state of variables.
- *Code editing:* VS Code provides powerful code editing features such as syntax highlighting, code completion, and IntelliSense (a smart code completion feature) for multiple languages.
- *Built-in Git integration:* It has built-in integration with Git, which makes it easy for developers to collaborate and share code with other members of a team.
- *Extensibility and customisability:* VS Code is highly extensible and customisable; it has a large library of plugins and extensions that can be added to the IDE to provide additional functionality and support for various programming languages and frameworks.

It also has multi-platform support, a large and active community, and is free and open source.

VS Code is a powerful and versatile IDE that can help developers work more efficiently and effectively. It's known for its speed, flexibility and the ability to integrate with a wide range of tools and services.

Latest version: 1.74

URL: <https://code.visualstudio.com/>

Operating systems supported: Windows 7 or later, OS X 10.10 or later, Linux
You can use `vscode.dev` for quick edits online too.

Eclipse

Eclipse is widely used by developers for a variety of programming languages and platforms. It's a Java-based IDE that can be used for development in

various languages. It's also highly extensible and customisable. Some of the benefits of using Eclipse include:

- *Cross-platform compatibility:* Eclipse runs on multiple platforms, including Windows, Linux, and macOS, which makes it accessible to a wide range of developers.
- *Extensibility and customisability:* Eclipse is highly extensible and customisable. It has a large library of plugins and extensions that can be added to the IDE to provide additional functionality and support for various programming languages and frameworks.
- *Built-in support for Java development:* It has built-in support for Java development, including features such as code completion, refactoring, and error checking, making it a popular choice for Java developers.
- *Support for multiple languages:* Eclipse supports development in multiple languages, including Java, C++, Python, and more, which makes it a versatile choice for developers working on a variety of projects.
- *Built-in version control integration:* It provides built-in support for version control systems, such as Git and SVN, which makes it easy for developers to collaborate and share code with other members of a team.

This free and open source IDE has a large and active community

Eclipse is a powerful and versatile IDE that can help developers work more efficiently and effectively, and can be a great choice for a wide range of development projects.

Latest version: 4.23

URL: <https://www.eclipse.org/>

Operating systems supported: macOS, Windows and Linux

IntelliJ IDEA

Developed by JetBrains, IntelliJ IDEA is primarily used for Java development, but also supports other languages such